

Van Cleanliness & Organization

Work Van Safety Module

Why a Clean, Organized Van Matters

A clean work van isn't just about appearances. Poor housekeeping increases the risk of slips, trips, and falls. Loose items can become dangerous projectiles in a sudden stop or crash. Safety agencies consistently link good housekeeping with fewer injuries and better efficiency.

The Hidden Dangers of Clutter

- **Projectiles:** Loose tools or boxes can fly forward in a collision and strike the driver or passengers.
- **Pedal Obstruction:** Objects on the floor can roll under the pedals, interfering with braking or acceleration.
- **Hidden Hazards:** Trash and spills can hide sharp objects, create bad odors, and attract pests.

A CLEAN VAN = SAFER DRIVER + TIME SAVED + PROFESSIONAL IMAGE

Main Risk Areas Inside the Van

1. FLOOR & WALKWAY

- Keep the floor clear of tools, cords, and loose parts.
- Immediately clean or wipe up spills when safe to do so.
- **Never** leave items where your feet or pedals need to move.

2. DRIVER AREA / CAB

- Keep dashboard, seats, and footwells free of loose items.
- Secure small items (phones, tablets, clipboards) to prevent sliding.

- Only keep what you actually need for the current day within reach.

3. CARGO AREA & TOOLS

- Store heavy items low and as far forward/secured as possible.
- Use bins and racks for small tools.
- Ensure materials won't fall out when doors are opened.
- Keep chemicals in sealed containers.

4. TRASH & PERSONAL ITEMS

- Use a small trash bag—empty it daily.
- Remove food containers and cups immediately to prevent odors/pests.
- Remove unnecessary personal items to reduce clutter.

Daily Routines & Expectations

A regular cleaning and removal schedule makes good housekeeping easier and keeps the workplace safer and more efficient.

Daily Cleanliness Routine

START OF SHIFT

- ✓ Do a quick walk-through of the van.
- ✓ Remove any trash or items that do not belong.
- ✓ Make sure your main tools are in their proper spots.
- ✓ **Critical Check:** Confirm the driver area is clear (nothing loose on floor, seat, or dash).

DURING THE DAY

- ✓ Put tools back where they belong after *each* job.
- ✓ Close bins, drawers, and doors fully before driving.
- ✓ Wipe up any spills as soon as possible.

END OF SHIFT

- ✓ Throw away all trash.
- ✓ Put every tool and part back in its place.
- ✓ Check that heavy items are secured and cannot shift.
- ✓ Take home or remove personal items you do not need for tomorrow.

Behavior Expectations

Every driver is responsible for the condition of the van they operate. The van should be:

- **Safe to drive:** No loose items interfering with pedals or visibility.
- **Clean enough for inspection:** A supervisor or customer should be able to look inside at any time.
- **Organized:** Tools and materials can be found quickly without digging through piles.

Remember:

"A clean, organized van protects you, protects company equipment, and shows respect for the job."